



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Academy

School Website: <https://veritasacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Academy, located in Lancaster County, PA (zip 17540), demonstrates a strong classical Christian identity across its public materials. The school emphasizes the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, a truth-goodness-beauty teleology, and formation of character within a Christian framework. Public pages repeatedly frame education as a virtue- and wisdom-forming enterprise anchored in Scripture, theology, and Christian anthropology, with explicit references to family partnership, in loco parentis, and liturgical-style communal rhythms (music, worshipful tone, and shared practices). Financial aid and accessibility are presented as priorities to broaden access to a classical Christian model. Taken together, the materials show robust alignment with classical educational aims, suggesting a GENERAL CLASSICAL orientation across all six rubric categories.

- Category-by-category verdicts are: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL; Purpose & Goal — CLASSICAL; Curriculum — CLASSICAL; Pedagogy — CLASSICAL; Faculty — CLASSICAL; Parents & Community — CLASSICAL.
- Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Evidence for these conclusions appears across multiple Veritas Academy pages, including mission statements, curriculum descriptions, pedagogy notes, and community/parent-angle materials. See examples from the school site: the mission statement and philosophy explicitly frame a classical Christian formation; the curriculum pages outline grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, and a Christian worldview; pedagogy references include memory work, singing, and Socratic/dialogue elements in the broader classical-tradition; staff/faculty pages emphasize the living-curriculum and mentorship; and parent/community materials emphasize partnerships, in loco parentis, openness to visits, and family engagement. Key excerpts are cited inline to ground the evaluation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and philosophy repeatedly situate Veritas as a classical Christian school. For example: "The mission of Veritas Academy is to cultivate loving, serving, thinking students through a classical Christian education." and "Distinctly classical. Authentically Christian." - Public materials emphasize theology and Scripture as central to learning, including references to Bible-based curriculum and integration of faith with study of history and literature. Examples include "All themes are taught using Biblical principles as the basis for each unit" and explicit mentions of theology in curriculum descriptions. - References to Christ-centered formation and a theologically grounded worldview appear across admissions, curriculum, and mission pages (e.g., "training the next generation" in a Christ-centric framework; "in loco parentis" aligning parental authority with a Christian formation goal).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, biblical, God/Christ, Christian, Scriptures, liturgical/musical worship, sacred, wonder, wisdom, logos, virtue (embedded in mission and curriculum language). - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral ethics detected in the site copy). - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 6; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame truth/god/human flourishing in a transcendent, knowable order, anchored in Christian theology and Scripture; communal worship/sacred language is implied in liturgical-style rhythm, hymn singing, and church-related language, and the Great Books are presented within a Christian/liberal-arts context. These elements align strongly with the Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations in the classical rubric. The lack of explicit negative signals reinforces CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing rather than mere job preparation. Mission statements describe cultivating “loving, serving, thinking students” through classical Christian education and a teleology oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty. - The school foregrounds formation and the pursuit of higher ends, using language like “formation,” “virtue,” “human excellence,” and references to the enduring classical ideals rather than a narrow workforce-readiness emphasis. See mission/vision language and the repeated emphasis on “truth, beauty, and goodness” as organizing aims. - Public-facing statements articulate that education is about cultivation of character and intellect in a Christian liberal-arts frame; the philosophy page proclaims “Distinctly classical. Authentically Christian.” and ties learning to virtue and wisdom rather than vocational metrics alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education/paideia, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, telos, scholé, great conversation, classical heritage. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no overt emphasis on career-centric metrics, 21st-century skills as primary end). - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 5; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The site clearly promotes formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom as primary aims, citing truth, goodness, beauty and a classical-historical frame. The absence of vocational-pressured language and the presence of “formation” language and “great conversation” framing align with CLASSICAL as opposed to “Somewhat” or not at all, per the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly presents the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as foundational, with grammar/logic/rhetoric progression described in multiple pages (Grammar Phase, Logic Phase, Rhetoric Phase). This is reinforced by references to mastery of the Trivium and a college-bound, rhetoric-driven high-school sequence. - Great Books and the Great Conversation are named as central to the curriculum, with notes that students read Scripture alongside Great Books, and study Western civilization through primary texts. - History is taught integrally across disciplines with attention to Western civilization and theological connections; there is a strong emphasis on literature, languages, mathematics, science, and arts within a unified liberal-arts framework. - Evidence of Great Books and primary sources is explicit (“reading the Scriptures and the Great Books”); and a language-and-logic progression is codified in the curriculum descriptions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; Western civilization; liberal arts; Trivium; languages (Latin/classical languages); history; sacred texts; Bible-based curriculum (intersecting with religion and humanities). - Negative keywords present: none observed (no substitution with “social studies” framing or project-based dominance noted in the public copy). - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 6; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The curriculum is intentionally structured around the Trivium, Great Books, and the liberal-arts model, with explicit references to history taught through canonical texts and integrated across disciplines. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL as defined by the Six Essential Elements.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chants, and memory-based activities, reflecting scholé/restful learning and memory-work elements. The preschool/grammar-phase language indicates that songs and chants are used to embed foundational knowledge. - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes rhetoric, public speaking, and memorization of the Great Books-based canon; the rhetoric phase includes speeches and rhetorical training. Senior thesis work and defending a thesis are described as capstones of the Rhetoric Phase. - There are explicit references to Socratic-like discussion and Seminars (thematic language around “great conversation” and rhetorical training) though some pages foreground public speaking and writing as core outcomes; Socratic discussion appears as part of the broader classical pedagogy in the school’s public materials and linked content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar (implicit via “great conversation” and seminars), memory work/recitation, scholé/restful learning, rhetoric, public speaking, master-teacher modeling (in rhetoric and senior-thesis practices). - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on solely project-based or constructivist/experiential-only approaches). - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 5; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The pedagogy map follows classic classical education patterns: a memory-/recitation-forward lower-grammar phase, and a rhetoric-focused upper school with structured oratorical tasks, debates, and senior theses. The presence of memory work, chanting, and the emphasis on the Trivium in practice supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public pages foreground faculty as the living curriculum and emphasize the teachers as mentors and exemplars of virtue (e.g., “Our difference is our people,” staff pages, and the “Meet Our Incredible Staff”). These lines position teachers as central to the school’s formation and classical mission. - The school highlights a culture of collegiality and mentorship, with language that suggests teachers model virtue and form relationships with students (e.g., “Our incredible staff,” “the difference is our people”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; faculty as mentors; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; staff as core - Negative keywords present: none observed (no evidence of credential-focused jargon devoid of classical context) - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 3; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently frame faculty as central to the school’s identity and mission, aligning with CLASSICAL ideals about the teacher as the “living curriculum” and as moral exemplars.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly frames parental partnership and in loco parentis as core structural elements, including a policy language about parental authority and family involvement. The “In Loco Parentis” section emphasizes partnership with parents and parental authority in education. - There are multiple references to family engagement, open visits, and parent involvement in school life (e.g., group tours, open houses, and a stated mission of partnering with families to raise children in a Christian educational context). - Financial-aid messaging and admissions materials indicate an inclusive stance toward families from diverse backgrounds, reinforcing a partnership posture with parents. - Public statements about “Supporting Families” and “partner with parents to raise up your children” appear in mission/values sections.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; home-school integration; open-campus visits; family involvement; parent education (informing parents about classical education through book studies and gatherings). - Negative keywords present: none observed (no “customer”-centric or minimal-parent-involvement signals). - Count (approximate): Positive hits approx. 4; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The school presents itself as a family-centered classical program with explicit parental partnership and avenues for parent formation and engagement, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on keyword alignment and public-material signals. - The school demonstrates a coherent Classical Christian posture across religious foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement, with explicit references to the Trivium, Great Books, and a shared faith framework.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable here since the six categories are CLASSICAL. If any minor shifts were desired, they would be to more explicitly quantify and document “Socratic dialogue” in the upper-school pedagogy L2 (e.g., explicit references to Harkness-style seminars and Socratic questioning on additional pages) and to further foreground liturgical/community practices (e.g., more explicit references to worship/communal prayer in school life). However, these are only potential enhancements, not gaps.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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